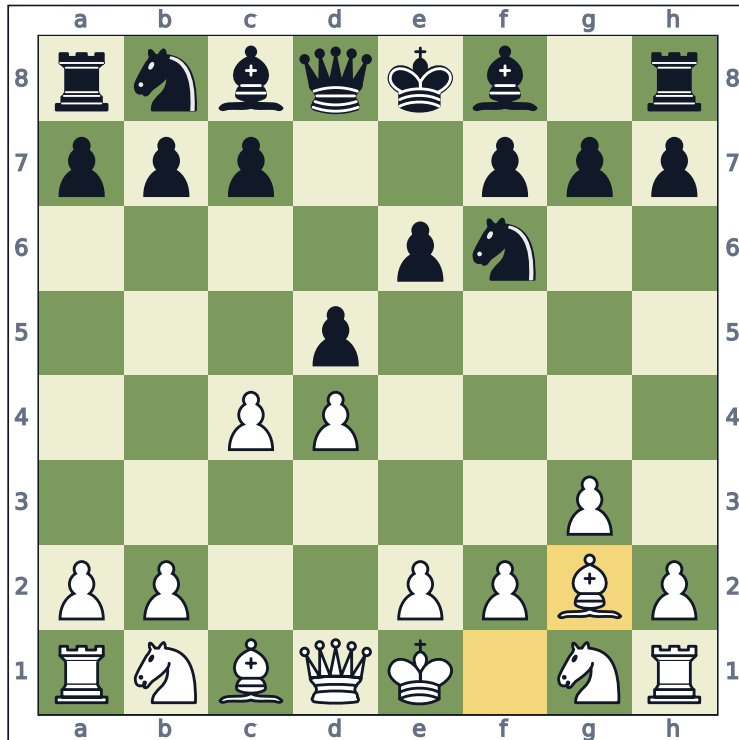


CATALAN OPENING

Catalan Opening

ECO E01 | 2 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.24 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Strategic and flexible: small move-order choices decide which pawn structure appears.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E01 covers Catalan Opening. White combines d4 and c4 with a g2 bishop, seeking long-term pressure and excellent piece activity. The diagram uses the featured line Catalan Opening: Open Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the long diagonal, recover a sacrificed c-pawn without losing coordination, and press queenside weaknesses patiently.

BLACK'S GOALS

Choose whether to hold c4, return it for development, or close the diagonal; seek ...c5 or ...e5 for freedom.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 challenge the center; White often uses Ne5, Qc2, and a4 to recover or undermine c4.

PIECE MAP

The g2 bishop is the soul of White's position. Black must manage the a8-h1 diagonal and queenside development. White's g2 bishop makes the long diagonal a strategic asset.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

White should not rush to regain a pawn if doing so loses the initiative; Black should not cling to it at any cost. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A top-class strategic opening, especially strong for players who enjoy durable pressure rather than forced attacks.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E01 line

This section preserves all 2 names and defining routes assigned to E01 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Catalan Opening: Open Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2

002 Catalan Opening: Tarrasch Defense

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2 c5 5. Nf3 Nc6